

JavaScript to be the default language for GNOME

JavaScript is becoming a force to reckon with. GNOME developers have at last decided to stick to JavaScript to write applications for the desktop environment. However, the developers are still recommending C to write system libraries. "During the GNOME Developer Experience Hackfest this week, one of the major goals we identified was the need to pick a single language to give a simple answer to those who ask, 'How do I write a GNOME app?'" Our decision is to support JavaScript as the first class language for GNOME application development," read a blog posting by Collabora engineer and GNOME developer, Travis Reitter.

Explaining the reason for choosing JavaScript, Travis added, "Our language of choice needs to be dynamic and high level. There is already momentum in the GNOME Project for JavaScript; it's used in GNOME Shell and GNOME Documents. There's a lot of work going into the language to make it especially fast, embeddable, and framework-agnostic. JavaScript is increasingly being seen as a first class desktop programming language; it is being used in Windows 8, in mobile platforms, and for local Web applications. JavaScript is self-contained; it doesn't come with its own set of core libraries, which makes it more convenient for us when integrating it into the platform."

Until now, there were no specific set of tools to write an application for the GNOME desktop environment. With this announcement, JavaScript will become the default language for GNOME applications.

The 'Me Against Rape' Android app to improve safety of women

Here comes an Android app that will help women to safeguard their right to freedom of mobility and security.

Named 'Me Against Rape', this safety mobile application has been developed by three engineers from Nashik in Maharashtra. The app is available for free download from the Google Play store for Android. It is for both smartphones and tablets.

The app allows users to raise an alarm by sending a text message along with the location details to a pre-selected number. The app keeps sending updates of the changing location to the number every ten minutes, making tracking easy. It does not end here. The mobile can also start recording the incident, in case the victim wants to use it as evidence in court.

Mozilla introduces 'Boilerplate' to help developers make Firefox OS apps

Mozilla is running its Firefox operating system for smartphones on top gear, as developer Robert Nyman has announced a tool, which will help developers to start creating applications for the Firefox OS or even porting an existing Web application to it. Dubbed the Firefox OS Boilerplate App, the tool will have several basic features, which almost all applications have in common. "The idea is to avoid any dependency on external libraries or resources, but rather be self-contained," wrote Nyman in a blog post.

"As the name implies, Firefox OS Boilerplate App will provide you with the most basic features to get started with building an app from scratch, or tools to port your existing Web app. The easiest way to get started with installing it and testing the various features is to navigate to the Firefox OS Boilerplate App in the Web browser on a Firefox OS device or in the Firefox OS Simulator," added Nyman.

Use your Android phone to pay your bills!



The Reserve Bank of India has given the go-ahead to a special card reader that will allow you to pay your bills via your Android phone. Priced at Rs 1500, the cigarette box-sized card reader that will come along with an Android phone, can perform all tasks that a POS terminal can. Citibank has taken the first step to adopt this technology, which has been developed by Bengaluru-based Ezetap Mobile Solutions. The company has obtained regulatory clearances for the launch of the card reader.

To use the technology, the card reader has to be connected to an Android-based smartphone and a specified app is also required to run it. The merchants can also install the app on their mobiles, which can update their systems about the payment. According to the report, "The technology is not something new; the only difference is that while earlier innovations involved a separate platform, this one replicates the card POS and somewhat blurs the lines between credit card and mobile payments."

Twitter rolls out Android update with new features

Twitter, the social messaging company, is rolling out its latest update for Android devices being used across the globe. This update is said to come